PAST TENSE

SIMPLE PAST
(past form of the tense)

Series of completed actions

- He sat down, took out a notebook and pen, and started writing.
- He entered the room, turned in my direction, and smiled at me.



Habits in the past

- John played the piano when he was a child.
- I was good at dancing when I was a teenager.



Completed action in the past

- Sarah baked a cake yesterday.
- I went to bed at 10 last night.
- We ordered pizza on Friday.



Duration in the past

- He stayed up all night.
- We lived in Chicago for a year.
- We played baseball all day.



PAST CONTINUOUS
(was/were+verb+ing)

Action before & after a specific time

Yesterday at noon, I was eating lunch.





To start a story / create an atmosphere

While I was driving to work yesterday...

Repeated action (often with "always")

My last roommate was always leaving dirty dishes in the sink.



Interrupted continuous past action

I was watching a movie when she called.



Parallel actions

I was reading while my brother was playing guitar.



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